Discipline Code

This code explains how cards and bans work in the Copperline Community League and how a player or club can appeal. Disciplinary decisions are made by the league office and the discipline panel, not by the volunteer help desk. The help desk can only report the figures in this code and the card counts held on the player records.

Yellow cards

A yellow card is a caution. It is shown for unsporting behaviour, dissent, persistent fouling, delaying the restart of play, entering or leaving the pitch without the referee's permission, or a reckless tackle that does not deserve a sending off. Yellow cards are counted across the whole season for each player.

Five yellow cards in a season earn an automatic one-match ban. The ban is served in the player's club's next league fixture after the fifth card is recorded. Players on three or four yellow cards are reminded by the league office after each round so that captains can plan their squads. The player's yellow card count is shown on their stats record and is updated after the referee's report is processed, usually within two days of the match.

Yellow cards do not reset at the break

The mid-season break does not reset yellow card counts. A yellow card collected in September still counts towards the five that earn a ban in November. Counts are only reset at the end of the season. Cup matches have their own card rules, which are set out in the cup competition rules.

Second yellow and red cards

A second yellow card in the same match is shown together with a red card. The player must leave the technical area and the pitch, and the team plays on with one fewer player. A straight red card is shown for serious foul play, violent conduct, spitting, denying an obvious goal-scoring opportunity by handling or by a foul, or using offensive, insulting or abusive language.

A red card carries a ban of at least two matches. The discipline panel may add matches depending on the seriousness of the offence and the player's record. The ban starts with the club's next league fixture. A player who has received a red card may not take part in any league or cup match for that club until the ban has been served, and may not sit in the technical area during the ban.

Reporting and records

The referee submits a written match report within 24 hours. Any card, and the reason for it, is entered in the report. The league office records the card against the player id (for example PL-114) and updates the counts. Captains can ask the league office to confirm a player's card count during office hours, Monday to Thursday, 18:00 to 21:00.

Appeals

A player or club may appeal a card or ban to the league office. The appeal must be made within 48 hours of the match report being published to the club. It must be in writing, from the club captain or secretary, and it must state the match, the player id and the grounds for the appeal. An appeal does not suspend a ban unless the discipline panel decides so. The panel's decision on an appeal is final for the season.

Serving a ban

A banned player must not appear on the team sheet for the match in which the ban is served. A club that plays a banned player loses the match 3-0 and the player receives an additional one-match ban. Captains must check their squad against the ban list on the league website before submitting the team sheet.

Behaviour that goes beyond cards

Abuse towards officials, opposing players or spectators, whether or not a card was shown, can be reported under the code of conduct. The discipline panel can issue fines, point deductions or longer bans in serious cases.